

Day 117 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Current Affairs in Indian Polity (11): JPC on 'One Nation, One Election' Gets Extension to Monsoon 2026

READING MATERIAL

Covers the 'One Nation, One Election' bills' Joint Parliamentary Committee (JPC) and its 2026 tenure extension.

Q: Which 2 bills is the JPC on 'One Nation, One Election' examining?

A: The Constitution (129th Amendment) Bill, and the Union Territories Laws (Amendment) Bill — both aiming to synchronise national and state elections.

Q: When was the JPC constituted, and who chairs it?

A: Constituted in December 2024 by Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla; chaired by P.P. Chaudhary (BJP), a former Union Minister of State for Law and Justice.

Q: What is the JPC's total membership, and its composition across the 2 Houses?

A: 39 members total — 27 from the Lok Sabha and 12 from the Rajya Sabha.

Q: What extension did the Lok Sabha grant the JPC in March 2026, and by when must it now report?

A: The JPC's tenure was extended (approved mid-March 2026) — it must now submit its report by the first day of the last week of the Monsoon Session 2026.

Q: What was the Lok Sabha's vote count when the 'One Nation, One Election' Bill was first introduced (17 December 2024)?

A: 269 members in favour, 198 opposed (a division vote).

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. The JPC on 'One Nation, One Election' examines the Constitution (129th Amendment) Bill and which other Bill?

- A. The Representation of People (Amendment) Bill
- B. The Union Territories Laws (Amendment) Bill ✓**
- C. The Election Commission (Reform) Bill
- D. The Delimitation Bill

Explanation: The Union Territories Laws (Amendment) Bill. [medium, web-research]

2. The JPC on 'One Nation, One Election' is chaired by:

- A. Om Birla
- B. P.P. Chaudhary ✓**
- C. Arjun Ram Meghwal
- D. Kiren Rijiju

Explanation: P.P. Chaudhary. [medium, web-research]

3. The JPC on 'One Nation, One Election' has a total membership of:

- A. 31
- B. 35
- C. 39 ✓**
- D. 45

Explanation: 39 members (27 Lok Sabha + 12 Rajya Sabha). [hard, web-research]

4. The JPC's report deadline was extended (mid-March 2026) to:

- A. Budget Session 2026
- B. Monsoon Session 2026 ✓**
- C. Winter Session 2026
- D. Budget Session 2027

Explanation: Monsoon Session 2026. [medium, web-research]

5. When the 'One Nation, One Election' Bill was introduced in the Lok Sabha (17 December 2024), the division vote result was:

A. 269 in favour, 198 opposed ✓

B. 300 in favour, 150 opposed

C. 220 in favour, 240 opposed

D. 350 in favour, 100 opposed

Explanation: 269 in favour, 198 opposed. [hard, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Ratio and Proportion

READING MATERIAL

Ratio & Proportion is 1 of 10 named Aptitude sub-skills, and real exam evidence shows it's tested through several distinct shapes, not just 'simplify this ratio'. Learn each shape as its own method.

Q: Real exam (2025): A man spends Rs.500 buying 12 tables and chairs. One table costs Rs.50, one chair costs Rs.40. Find the ratio of chairs to tables purchased.

A: Let tables= t , chairs= c . $t+c=12$ and $50t+40c=500$ (i.e. $5t+4c=50$). Substitute $t=12-c$: $5(12-c)+4c=50 \rightarrow 60-5c+4c=50 \rightarrow c=10$, so $t=2$. Ratio chairs:tables = $10:2 = 5:1$.

Q: Method — combining two ratios that share a common term: If $a:b=3:5$ and $b:c=7:8$, find $a:c$.

A: To chain two ratios, scale each so the SHARED term (b) matches in both. Here b is 5 in the first ratio and 7 in the second — $\text{LCM}(5,7)=35$. Scale $a:b=3:5$ by $\times 7 \rightarrow a:b=21:35$. Scale $b:c=7:8$ by $\times 5 \rightarrow b:c=35:40$. Now $a:b:c = 21:35:40$, so $a:c = 21:40$.

Q: Method — continued proportion (three terms in one ratio): If $a/10 = b/15 = c/20$, find $a:b:c$.

A: All three fractions equal the same constant, so $a:b:c$ is simply $10:15:20$, which reduces to $2:3:4$ (dividing by the HCF, 5).

Q: Method — chaining two ratios via a shared term: If $A:B=3:4$ and $B:C=8:9$, find $A:C$.

A: B is 4 in the first ratio and 8 in the second — scale the first ratio so B matches: multiply $A:B=3:4$ by 2 to get $A:B=6:8$. Now both ratios share $B=8$: $A:B:C = 6:8:9$. So $A:C = 6:9 = 2:3$.

Q: Method — mixture/alloy adjustment (add a pure ingredient to shift a ratio): A mixture of 60 L has acid:water = $2:1$. How much water must be added to make the ratio $1:2$?

A: Acid:water = $2:1$ in 60L means acid=40L, water=20L. We're only adding water (acid stays at 40L). We want acid:water = $1:2$, i.e. water = $2 \times \text{acid} = 80\text{L}$. Water to add = $80-20 = 60\text{L}$.

Q: Method — simplest form of an age ratio: Azhagan is 50 years old, his son is 10. What is the simplest ratio of their ages?

A: $50:10$ reduces (divide both by 10) to $5:1$.

Q: Method — finding an unknown in a proportion (cross-multiplication): If the numbers 2, 5, x , 20 (in that order) are in proportion, find x .

A: In proportion, $2:5 = x:20$, so $2 \times 20 = 5 \times x \rightarrow 40 = 5x \rightarrow x = 8$. (General rule: in $a:b=c:d$, $a \times d = b \times c$.)

Q: Method — the '4th proportional': Find the 4th proportional to 4, 16, and 7.

A: The 4th proportional x satisfies $4:16 = 7:x \rightarrow 4x = 16 \times 7 = 112 \rightarrow x = 28$.

Q: Method — splitting a total using a 3-part ratio and a given average: Three numbers are in ratio $3:5:7$ and their average is 60. Find the smallest number.

A: Average of 60 over 3 numbers means their total = 180. Split 180 in ratio $3:5:7$ (15 parts total): each part = $180/15 = 12$. Smallest = $3 \times 12 = 36$.

Q: Method — 'duplicate ratio' (squaring a ratio): What is the duplicate ratio of $2:7$?

A: The duplicate ratio of $a:b$ is $a^2:b^2$. So the duplicate ratio of $2:7$ is $4:49$.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. A woman spends Rs.620 buying 14 pens and notebooks. One pen costs Rs.30, one notebook costs Rs.50. Find the ratio of notebooks to pens purchased.

- A. 2:5
- B. 5:2 ✓**
- C. 3:4
- D. 4:3

Explanation: $p+n=14$; $30p+50n=620 \rightarrow 3p+5n=62$. Substitute $p=14-n$: $3(14-n)+5n=62 \rightarrow 42+2n=62 \rightarrow n=10$, $p=4$. Ratio notebooks:pens = $10:4 = 5:2$. [hard, authored]

2. If $x/8 = y/12 = z/20$, find $x:y:z$ in lowest terms.

- A. 2:3:5 ✓**
- B. 8:12:20
- C. 4:6:10
- D. 1:2:3

Explanation: $x:y:z = 8:12:20$, which reduces (divide by HCF=4) to $2:3:5$. [easy, authored]

3. If $P:Q = 2:3$ and $Q:R = 9:10$, find $P:R$.

A. 3:5 ✓

B. 2:5

C. 3:10

D. 9:20

Explanation: Scale $P:Q=2:3$ by 3 to get $P:Q=6:9$, matching $Q=9$ from $Q:R=9:10$. So $P:Q:R=6:9:10$, giving $P:R=6:10=3:5$. [medium, authored]

4. A 40 L mixture has milk:water = 3:1. How much water must be added to change the ratio to 3:2?

A. 5 L

B. 10 L ✓

C. 8 L

D. 6 L

Explanation: Milk:water=3:1 in 40L means milk=30L, water=10L. Milk stays fixed; we want water= $(2/3) \times \text{milk} = (2/3) \times 30 = 20$ L. Water to add = $20 - 10 = 10$ L. [hard, authored]

5. If 5, 8, x, 24 are in proportion, find x.

A. 12.5

B. 15 ✓

C. 16

D. 20

Explanation: $5:8 = x:24 \rightarrow 5 \times 24 = 8x \rightarrow 120 = 8x \rightarrow x = 15$. [easy, authored]

6. Find the 4th proportional to 3, 12, and 9.

A. 27

B. 36 ✓

C. 30

D. 33

Explanation: $3:12 = 9:x \rightarrow 3x = 12 \times 9 = 108 \rightarrow x = 36$. [easy, authored]

7. Three numbers are in the ratio 2:3:4 and their average is 45. Find the largest number.

A. 40

B. 50

C. 60 ✓

D. 45

Explanation: Average 45 over 3 numbers means total=135. 9 parts total, each part=15. Largest = $4 \times 15 = 60$. [medium, authored]

8. What is the duplicate ratio of 3:5?

A. 6:10

B. 9:25 ✓

C. 9:10

D. 3:25

Explanation: Duplicate ratio = square each term: $3^2:5^2 = 9:25$. [easy, authored]

9. A sum of Rs.450 is divided among 100 boys and girls, each boy getting Rs.5.10 and each girl Rs.3.60. Find the number of girls.

A. 20

B. 30

C. 40 ✓

D. 50

Explanation: Let girls=g, boys=100-g. $3.6g + 5.1(100-g) = 450 \rightarrow 3.6g + 510 - 5.1g = 450 \rightarrow -1.5g = -60 \rightarrow g = 40$. [hard, authored]

10. A father's age (40) to his daughter's age (8) — what is the simplest ratio?

A. 5:1 ✓

B. 8:1

C. 4:1

D. 10:1

Explanation: 40:8 reduces ($\div 8$) to 5:1. [easy, authored]

Part C – General English: Prose: "The Last Lesson" — Alphonse Daudet

READING MATERIAL

Set in Alsace, France, after its annexation by Prussia following the Franco-Prussian War — the new Prussian rulers have banned French from being taught in schools, and this is the final French lesson for M. Hamel's class, narrated by a young student, Franz.

Q: Who wrote "The Last Lesson", and what is its historical setting?

A: Alphonse Daudet. Set in Alsace, France, after France's defeat in the Franco-Prussian War (1870-71), when the region of Alsace-Lorraine was annexed by Prussia/Germany, which then banned the teaching of French in local schools (German was to be taught instead).

Q: Why was Franz (the narrator) afraid to go to school that morning, and what unusual sight did he notice at the town hall on the way?

A: He was afraid because he hadn't learnt his lesson on participles and feared M. Hamel's punishment. On the way, he noticed an unusually large crowd gathered around the bulletin board at the town hall (where news of the Prussian occupation/orders was posted).

Q: What was unusual about the classroom atmosphere and M. Hamel's appearance/clothing when Franz arrived, and who were sitting on the back benches?

A: The classroom was unusually quiet (not the normal noisy bustle). M. Hamel was dressed in his special green coat, frilled shirt, and silk cap — clothes normally worn only for inspections or prize days. Village elders were sitting on the back benches, having come to attend this final French class themselves.

Q: What announcement did M. Hamel make to the class, and what does this signify?

A: He announced that this was the LAST French lesson — an order had come from Berlin that only German would be taught in the schools of Alsace and Lorraine from then on. It signifies the loss of their language and cultural identity under foreign occupation.

Q: How does the story end, and what does M. Hamel's final gesture/words symbolize?

A: M. Hamel, overcome with emotion, takes a piece of chalk and writes 'Vive La France!' ('Long live France!') on the blackboard, then silently gestures with his hand that the class — and the school — is dismissed. It symbolizes deep patriotism and the enduring importance of one's mother tongue and national identity, even in defeat.

Q: In a real exam's character-matching question, who are M. Hamel, Franz, Hauser, and Wachter?

A: M. Hamel = the Teacher. Franz = the Student (narrator). Hauser = an Old man (one of the village elders attending the last lesson). Wachter = the Blacksmith (another villager present) — confirmed via a real TNPSC match-the-following question.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "The Last Lesson" was written by:

- A. Munshi Premchand
- B. Alphonse Daudet ✓**
- C. Ruskin Bond
- D. Mark Twain

Explanation: Alphonse Daudet. [easy, web-research]

2. Why was Franz afraid to go to school that morning?

- A. He was late
- B. He didn't know his lesson on participles ✓**
- C. He had forgotten his books
- D. He had a fight with a classmate

Explanation: He hadn't learnt his lesson on participles. [medium, web-research]

3. What did Franz notice as he passed the town hall?

- A. The bulletin board was empty
- B. A large crowd was gathered around the bulletin board ✓**
- C. People were celebrating a victory
- D. A notice about a school holiday

Explanation: A large crowd was gathered around the bulletin board. [medium, web-research]

4. What was unusual about the classroom atmosphere when Franz entered?

- A. The students were all talking loudly

B. M. Hamel was angry and shouting

C. The classroom was unusually quiet ✓

D. The windows were all broken

Explanation: Unusually quiet. [medium, web-research]

5. What was M. Hamel wearing that surprised Franz?

A. His everyday clothes

B. His green coat, frilled shirt, and silk cap ✓

C. A military uniform

D. A teacher's black robe

Explanation: His green coat, frilled shirt, and silk cap. [medium, web-research]

6. Who were sitting on the back benches of the classroom that day?

A. New students

B. Visitors from Berlin

C. Village elders ✓

D. M. Hamel's family

Explanation: Village elders. [medium, web-research]

7. What did M. Hamel announce to the class?

A. There would be no more classes ever

B. French would no longer be taught — only German from now on ✓

C. The school was closing for summer vacation

D. A new headmaster was arriving

Explanation: French would no longer be taught. [easy, web-research]

8. What did M. Hamel write on the blackboard at the end of the last lesson?

A. "Goodbye, my students"

B. "Vive La France!" ✓

C. "Long live the Prussians"

D. Nothing — he left silently

Explanation: "Vive La France!" ("Long live France!"). [medium, web-research]

9. In the story, match the characters to their roles: M. Hamel, Franz, Hauser, Wachter.

A. M.Hamel=Student, Franz=Teacher, Hauser=Blacksmith, Wachter=Old man

B. M.Hamel=Teacher, Franz=Student, Hauser=Old man, Wachter=Blacksmith ✓

C. M.Hamel=Old man, Franz=Blacksmith, Hauser=Teacher, Wachter=Student

D. M.Hamel=Blacksmith, Franz=Old man, Hauser=Student, Wachter=Teacher

Explanation: M.Hamel=Teacher, Franz=Student, Hauser=Old man, Wachter=Blacksmith. [hard, question-bank-2022]